



Top row: The old visual theme. Bottom row: the redesigned visual theme with transparency and flat icons

display problem.

In 2011 Apple released in what can be regarded as the most important and significant version of the iOS operating system. iOS 5 was a game changer of sorts and introduced a plethora of features that really upped the momentum for iOS capable devices. For starters iOS 5 introduced Siri – a voice controlled assistant for the device. It allows the

user to ask questions for searching and executing phone functions. Granted it wasn't perfect and was found to be a hassle for quite a few users, but Siri as a concept was a significant start and had great potential. Apple also really upped the ante and came up with iCloud, a neat way to sync data and applications on the cloud. Apple also added a notifications centre similar to the one stocked in Android devices. The rich design and the no hassle user interface became Apple trademarks, along with skeumorphic design philosophies and the steely colour palette.

iOS 6 made the news not for massive design overhauls or changes but for the decision to discontinue with Google Maps. The introduction turned out to be a flop and quite an embarrassment to Apple, a company that is known for perfection. The CEO Tim Cook even issued an apology for the Apple Maps faux pas. But apart from that, iOS did add some additional upgrades for its successful voice control feature Siri. Users now had voice access to a large number of features and that really improved the UX of the iOS operating System. Other notable additions included the notification centre, official Facebook integration, a passbook app for financial transac-